

Write APA Style Documents Using Quarto

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Abstract

This document is a template demonstrating the apaquarto format. The template demonstrates the use of in-text citations, possessive citations, masked citations, meta-analytpic citations, block quotes, equations, figures, and tables. Creating appendices is demonstrated.

Impact Statement

The apaquarto template allows writers to apply APA style consistently with minimal fuss and bother.

Keywords: APA Style, Quarto, Markdown, apaquarto

Supplemental materials: Documentation and web app at <https://wjschne.github.io/apaquarto/>

Write APA Style Documents Using Quarto

This is my introductory paragraph. The title will be placed above it automatically. *Do not start with an introductory heading* (e.g., “Introduction”). The title acts as your Level 1 heading for the introduction.

Details about writing headings with markdown in APA style are [here](#). In general, level 1 headings should be reserved for the Method, Results, Discussion, References, and Appendices sections.

YAML metadata

At the top of the apaquarto document, there is a lot of metadata (e.g., title, authors, affiliations, abstract, and so forth) written in YAML. Although the various options apaquarto are all documented, keeping track of them all can be difficult. Generating the initial YAML metadata can be easier if one begins with the [apa7maker](#) web app.

Citations

See [here](#) for instructions on setting up citations and references. A parenthetical citation requires square brackets ([Cameron & Trivedi, 2013](#)). This reference was in my bibliography file. An in-text citation is done like so:

Cameron and Trivedi ([2013](#)) make some important points.

See [here](#) for explanations, examples, and citation features exclusive to apaquarto. For example, apaquarto can automatically handle possessive citations:

Cameron and Trivedi’s ([2013](#)) position differed from Brown’s ([2012, pp. 1–2](#)) take on the matter.

Masking Author Identity for Peer Review

Setting `mask` to `true` will remove author names, affiliations, and correspondence from the title page. Any references listed in the `masked-citations` field will be masked as well. See [here](#) for more information.

Here is a masked citation ([Schneider & McGrew, 2012](#)).

Meta-analytic citations

By default, any references in the `nocite` field in your YAML heading will be assumed to be meta-analytic references that will appear in the reference section with an asterisk. If you want to use `nocite` but do not want references prefixed with asterisks, then set the `meta-analysis` field to `false`.

It is possible to cite meta-analytic references in text. For example, Cohen et al. (2003) is listed in the `nocite` field.

Block Quotes

Sometimes you want to give a longer quote that needs to go in its own paragraph. Block quotes are on their own line starting with the `>` character. For example, Austen's (1814/1990) *Mansfield Park* has some memorable insights about the mind:

If any one faculty of our nature may be called more wonderful than the rest, I do think it is memory. There seems something more speakingly incomprehensible in the powers, the failures, the inequalities of memory, than in any other of our intelligences. The memory is sometimes so retentive, so serviceable, so obedient; at others, so bewildered and so weak; and at others again, so tyrannic, so beyond control! We are, to be sure, a miracle every way; but our powers of recollecting and of forgetting do seem peculiarly past finding out. (p. 163)

Math and Equations

Inline math uses L^AT_EX syntax with single dollar signs. For example, the reliability coefficient of my measure is $r_{XX} = .95$.

If you want to display and refer to a specific formula, enclose the formula in two dollar signs. After the second pair of dollar signs, place the label in curly braces. The label should have an `#eq-` prefix. To refer to the formula, use the same label but with the `@` symbol. For example, Equation 1 is Euler's Identity, which is much admired for its elegance.

$$e^{i\pi} + 1 = 0 \tag{1}$$

A more practical example is the z-score equation seen in Equation 2.

$$z = \frac{X - \mu}{\sigma} \quad (2)$$

If no identifier label is given, a centered equation in display mode will have no identifying number:

$$\sigma_e = \sigma_y \sqrt{1 - r_{xy}^2}$$

Using Footnotes

A footnote is usually displayed at the bottom of the page on which the footnote occurs. A short note can be specified with the `^[My note here]` syntax.¹ A longer note can be specified with the `[^id]` syntax with the text specified on a separate line like so `[^id]: Text here.`²

A regular paragraph without any indentation is not part of the footnote and will be part of the main body of the document.

Displaying Figures

Do you want the tables and figures to be at the end of the document? You can set the `floatsintext` option to false. The reference labels will work no matter where they are in the text.

A reference label for a figure must have the prefix `fig-`, and in a code chunk, the caption must be set with `fig-cap`. Captions are in `title case`.

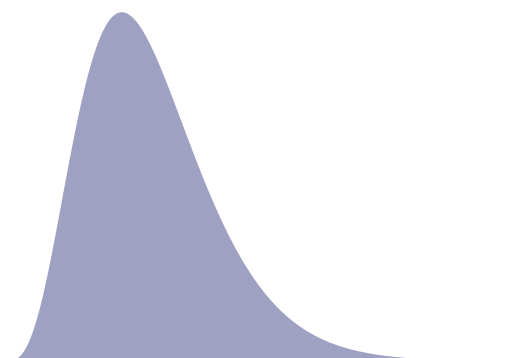
¹Here is my short footnote!

²This is a longer footnote. If it has multiple paragraphs, subsequent paragraphs need to be indented with two tabs.

This paragraph is still part of the footnote because it is indented with two tabs.

Figure 1

The Figure Caption



Note. This is the note below the figure.

To refer to any figure or table, use the @ symbol followed by the reference label (e.g., [Figure 1](#)).

Displaying Tables

We can make a table the same way as a figure. Generating a table that conforms to APA format in all document formats can be tricky. When the table is simple, the `kable` function from knitr works well. Feel free to experiment with different methods, but my [apa7 package](#) adapts David Gohel's [flextable](#) package to make a wide variety of APA-styled tables. In [this blog series](#), I used `apa7` to recreate the 24 example tables from chapter 7 of the *APA Publication Manual*.

Table 1

The Table Caption.

Variable	<i>B</i>	<i>SE</i>	β	<i>t</i> (53,936)	<i>p</i>
Constant	13,003.44	390.92	.00	33.26	<.001
Carat	7,858.77	14.15	.93	555.36	<.001
Depth	−151.24	4.82	−.05	−31.38	<.001
Table	−104.47	3.14	−.06	−33.26	<.001

Note. This is the first paragraph.

This is a second paragraph.

To refer to this table in text, use the @ symbol followed by the reference label like so: As seen in [Table 1](#), the price of a diamond is related to several features of the diamond.

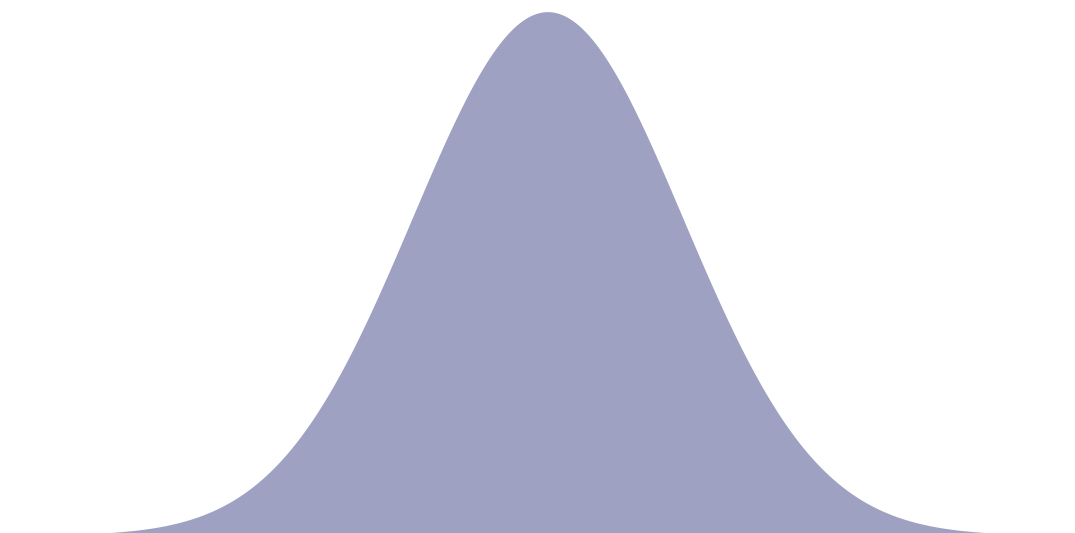
Tables and Figures Spanning Two Columns in Journal Mode

When creating tables and figures in journal mode, care must be taken not to make figures and tables wider than the columns, otherwise L^AT_EX sometimes makes them disappear.

As demonstrated in [Figure 2](#), you can make figures tables span the two columns by setting the `apa-twocolumn` chunk option to `true`.

Figure 2

A Figure Spanning Two Columns When in Journal Mode



Note. Figures in two-column mode are only different for journal mode in .pdf and typst documents

Hypotheses, Aims, and Objectives

The last paragraph of the introduction usually states the specific hypotheses of the study, often in a way that links them to the research design.

Method

General remarks on method. This paragraph is optional. Not all papers require each of these sections. Edit them as needed. Consult the [Journal Article Reporting Standards](#) for what is needed for your type of article.

Participants

Who are they? How were they recruited? Report criteria for participant inclusion and exclusion. Perhaps some basic demographic stats are in order. A table is a great way to avoid repetition in statistical reporting.

Measures

This section can also be titled **Materials** or **Apparatus**. Whatever tools, equipment, or measurement devices used in the study should be described.

Measure A

Describe Measure A.

Measure B

Describe Measure B.

Subscale B1. A paragraph after a 4th-level header will appear on the same line as the header.

Subscale B2. A paragraph after a 4th-level header will appear on the same line as the header.

Subscale B2a. A paragraph after a 5th-level header will appear on the same line as the header.

Subscale B2b. A paragraph after a 5th-level header will appear on the same line as the header.

Procedure

What did participants do? How are the data going to be analyzed?

Results

Descriptive Statistics

Describe the basic characteristics of the primary variables. My ideal is to describe the variables well enough that someone conducting a meta-analysis can include the study without needing to ask for additional information.

[Table 2](#) is an example of a plain markdown table. Note the that the caption begins with a colon.

Table 2

My Caption.

Letters	Numbers
A	1
B	2
C	3

Note. My note

Discussion

Describe results in non-statistical terms.

Limitations and Future Directions

Every study has limitations. Based on this study, some additional steps might include...

Conclusion

Describe the main point of the paper.

References

References marked with an asterisk indicate studies included in the meta-analysis.

Austen, J. (1990). *Mansfield Park*. Oxford University Press. (Original work published 1814)

*Bentley, M., Peerenboom, C., Hodge, F., Passano, E. B., Warren, H., & Washburn, M. (1929).

Instructions in regard to preparation of manuscript. *Psychological Bulletin*, 26(2), 57.

Brown, M. (2012). *How I killed Pluto and why it had it coming*. Spiegel & Grau.

- Cameron, A. C., & Trivedi, P. K. (2013). *Regression analysis of count data* (2nd ed.). Cambridge University Press. <https://doi.org/10.1017/CBO9781139013567>
- *Cohen, J., Cohen, P., West, S. G., & Aiken, L. S. (2003). *Applied multiple regression/correlation analysis for the behavioral sciences* (3rd ed.). Lawrence Erlbaum Associates.
- Schneider, W. J., & McGrew, K. S. (2012). The Cattell-Horn-Carroll model of intelligence. In D. P. Flanagan & P. L. Harrison (Eds.), *Contemporary intellectual assessment: Theories, tests, and issues* (3rd ed., pp. 99–144). Guilford Press. <https://psycnet.apa.org/record/2012-09043-004>

Appendix A

My Appendix

Any level 1 heading after the reference section (if it exists) is an appendix. If you do not specify a reference section, you will need to give the level-1 heading an identifier with an `#apx-` prefix. For example,

```
# My Appendix {#apx-a}
```

Appendices are created as level 1 headings with an `#apx-` prefix in the identifier.

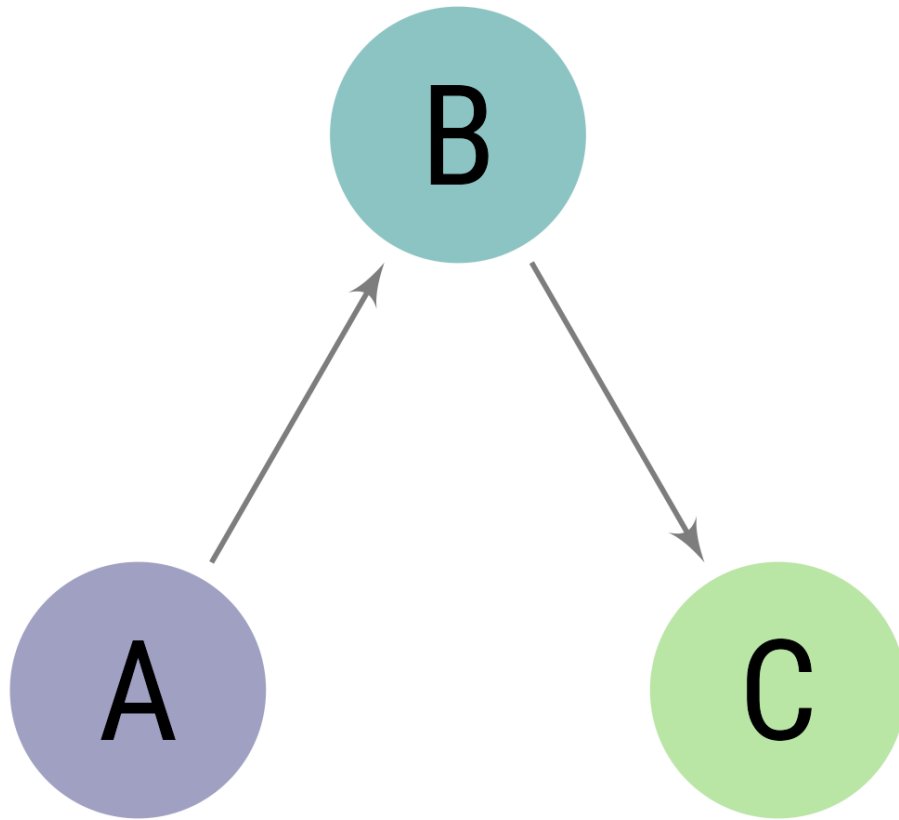
Appendix titles should be in title case and should describe the content of the appendix.

If there is only one appendix, the label inserted above the the appendix title will be **Appendix**. If there are multiple appendices, the labels **Appendix A**, **Appendix B**, **Appendix C** and so forth will be inserted above the titles.

To cite an appendix as a whole, reference it with the `@apx-` prefix. For example, see [Appendix A](#) and [Appendix B](#).

Figure A1

Appendix Figure



Note. A note below the figure

See [Figure A1](#), an example of an imported graphic using markdown syntax.

Appendix B

Another Appendix

[Appendix B](#) is an appendix with a contingency table (see [Table B1](#)).

Table B1

Contingency table

Gears	Automatic		Manual	
	<i>n</i>	%	<i>n</i>	%
3	15	78.9%	0	0.0%
4	4	21.1%	8	61.5%
5	0	0.0%	5	38.5%

Note. $\chi^2(2) = 20.94, p < .001$, Adj. Cramer's *V*

= .78